

MCP 101 · PART 1 · GET IT

MCP in *plain English*

MCP is one of the most common words thrown around in GTM right now. Yet, it is rarely explained in simple terms. This is the starting point: understand it first, then trust it, use it and stretch it.

MCP (Model Context Protocol) is a standard that lets AI clients like Claude or ChatGPT connect to tools and use them *without every integration being built from scratch*.

BEFORE MCP

9 BUILDS

	CRM	Email	Calls
Claude			
ChatGPT			
Copilot			

Every tool needed a custom integration for every AI client.

NOW

1 BUILD

Claude

ChatGPT

Copilot



One Backstory MCP server

One MCP server → multiple AI clients can use the tool.

If MCP still feels abstract, *start here.*

ANALOGY 1

The filing cabinet

Backstory	is the filing cabinet.
Claude	is the analyst.
MCP	is the badge that opens specific drawers.
Each tool	is one drawer.

ANALOGY 2

The standard plug

One standard plug. *Every appliance.*
Every wall.

Before, every device needed its own custom connection to your wall. The standard plug → any appliance works.



Your deal context, *wherever you work.*

01

Context where you work

Ask your assistant about an account and get answers from Backstory, without switching tabs.

02

Connect once

One server works across the AI clients your team already uses, so no one waits on a custom build.

03

Answers stay grounded

The assistant reads the emails, meetings and CRM activity Backstory captures.

TRY ASKING

"Catch me up on this deal"

"What are the key risks?"



Two things worth remembering

WORTH KNOWING

MCP is an open standard. Anthropic released it in November 2024, and OpenAI, Google and Microsoft have since added support.

DID YOU KNOW?

An AI client can only use the tools an MCP server chooses to expose. It sees the drawers it has been given, not the whole cabinet.

A standard way for AI tools to connect *directly* to Backstory data

01 · THE PROTOCOL

One standard, any client

Claude, Copilot and a growing list of AI clients speak MCP. Backstory exposes one server; you connect whichever assistant your team already lives in.

02 · THE BRIDGE

Live data, real permissions

The assistant sees accounts, deals and customer interactions in real time, through the signed-in user's own Backstory permissions.

03 · THE DIFFERENCE

No copy, paste and hope

Instead of pasting a summary into a chat window and hoping it's current, the assistant reads the record itself.

“Which of my accounts went quiet this month?” Asked in the assistant, answered from Backstory.

Situation search

SITUATION_SEARCH

Finds historically comparable past deals to use as precedent for a live one.

MCP ONLY

Not exposed anywhere else in Backstory. If a rep wants precedent, MCP is the only door.

IN PILOT

Available to pilot customers now. Still being tuned for the right level of granularity.

WHY IT MATTERS FOR GTM

Reps stop guessing how a deal like theirs was won.
Managers can coach from precedent instead of memory.

Find a similar deal to this one and tell me: how we were able to land the customer, and what I should avoid as I navigate this sales cycle:

<crm.example.com/opportunity/006...>

Loaded tools, used Backstory MCP integration >

I pulled up the current opportunity and ran it against similar historical deals. The closest match is a comparable net-new pilot, and I've pulled patterns across four similar wins to round out what to avoid.

Closest match: a net-new pilot at a mid-market software company

Nearly identical situation: a paid pilot, a buyer waiting on internal review, and a deal that needed rework on commercial structure.

How it was landed

- Separated subscription pricing from services pricing, which cleared up buyer confusion
- Ran a technical alignment session so stakeholders had what they needed for sign-off
- Sent the order form the moment approvals cleared

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE · MOCK DATA



Your AI assistant becomes an expert on *your* business

BEFORE MCP

- ✗ Copy account data out of Backstory, paste it into a chat, get generic advice
- ✗ Ask vague questions with no context behind them
- ✗ Switch between tools all day
- ✗ Analyze and report on data by hand

WITH MCP

- Your assistant already knows your accounts, deals and history
- Ask specific questions: "What are the risks on the Halden Freight deal?"
- Get insights based on your actual data, not generic best practices
- Work faster without leaving the assistant

Real questions, answered from your data

ACCOUNT EXECUTIVES

“What should I focus on this week?”

Reviews your pipeline, flags at-risk deals and suggests priorities.

“Help me prep for my call with Halden Freight.”

Summarizes recent activity, key contacts and talking points.

“Write a follow-up for the Vantage Retail deal.”

Drafts from the actual conversation history.

CUSTOMER SUCCESS

“Which accounts need attention?”

Reads engagement patterns and flags accounts showing risk.

“Summarize the last month with Corvia Health.”

Gives a full activity overview in one answer.

“What should I ask in my next QBR?”

Suggests topics based on account activity.

SALES MANAGERS

“How is my team tracking this quarter?”

Surfaces coaching opportunities across the team.

“Which deals are most likely to close this month?”

Weights opportunities by activity and engagement.

“Draft a pipeline review for leadership.”

Builds an executive summary with the key points.

What MCP does, and what it doesn't

WHAT MCP DOES

- ✓ Gives AI assistants your specific business context
- ✓ Returns faster, more relevant answers
- ✓ Cuts manual data gathering and analysis
- ✓ Grounds insights in your actual data

WHAT IT DOESN'T DO

- ✗ Replace human judgment or relationships
- ✗ Take actions in your CRM on its own
- ✗ Work well if Backstory data isn't up to date
- ✗ Replace a good sales process



Connect the assistant your team already uses

AVAILABLE NOW

Claude Desktop

Microsoft Copilot

Cursor

Goose

n8n

ChatGPT

COMING AND NOT YET

Gemini app · not yet

Support changes often. Check with your Backstory team for the latest list.

QUICK ANSWERS

Do we need to change how we work?

No. Keep using Backstory as you do today. MCP gives your AI tools access to that data.

What does it cost?

MCP is included with your Backstory subscription. The AI tools themselves may have their own cost.

Five steps to roll it out

01

Take stock

Which AI tools does your team already use?

02

Pick use cases

Which prompts would save the most time?

03

Connect

Work with Backstory to set up MCP.

04

Train

Show your team how to ask better questions.

05

Measure

Track time saved and answer quality.



UP NEXT • GET IT

The first *15 minutes*

